

Compare and Contrast

Name:

Date:

ACARA V9.0 — AC9E3LY05: Use comprehension strategies such as connecting to build literal and inferred meaning by identifying similarities and differences.

Learning Intention: I am learning to compare (find similarities) and contrast (find differences) between two things in a text.

Key Idea: To **compare** means to find how two things are **similar**. To **contrast** means to find how two things are **different**. Words like both, while, however and on the other hand signal comparisons.

Warm-Up: Name one way a bicycle and a car are similar, and one way they are different.

A. Read the Passage

Cats and Dogs

Cats and dogs are two of the most popular pets in the world, but they are quite different animals. Dogs are usually very social and love to play outside, going for walks and running after balls. Cats, on the other hand, are often more independent and enjoy quiet naps in sunny spots around the house.

Both animals can be loving companions and are known to comfort their owners when they are sad. While dogs usually need daily walks, cats are happy staying indoors and grooming themselves. Whether someone prefers a playful dog or a calm cat often depends on their own personality and lifestyle.

B. Similarities

Write 2 ways cats and dogs are similar, according to the passage.

.....
.....

C. Differences

Write 2 ways cats and dogs are different, according to the passage.

.....
.....

D. Venn Diagram Thinking

Imagine a Venn diagram with "Dogs" on one side and "Cats" on the other. Write one detail that would go in the middle (both), and one in each outer circle.

Both:

Only Dogs:

Only Cats:

Answer Guide & Extension Activities

Suggested Answers – B & C

B. Both can be loving companions; both can comfort their owners when sad.

C. Dogs are social and love outdoor play/walks; cats are independent and enjoy quiet naps indoors.

Suggested Answers – D

Answers will vary – e.g. Both: loving companions. Only Dogs: need daily walks. Only Cats: groom themselves, happy staying indoors.

High Five Stars – Self Assessment

★ I found similarities

★ I found differences

★ I used compare/contrast words

★ I organised ideas in a Venn diagram

Extension Activity

Choose two other animals you know well and write one similarity and one difference between them.

Parent/Teacher Tip

Comparing everyday items (two fruits, two books, two games) is a fun, low-pressure way to build compare and contrast thinking at home.

Reflection

Was it easier to find similarities or differences between cats and dogs? Why do you think that is?
